

University Of Ghana- Department of Computer Science

DCIT 208 – Software Engineering

Individual Assignment IA2 — Client Interview and Requirement Transformation

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Project Title: ArchiVerse — A Centralized Project Tracking and Client Engagement System for Asamoah Welbeck & Associates

Team Repository: <https://github.com/Dept-of-Comp-Sci-University-of-Ghana/dcit208-client-project-2026-team-engineering-repository-seg26-44-jaskon-tech>

Individual Repository: <https://github.com/Dept-of-Comp-Sci-University-of-Ghana/dcit208-individual-engineering-evidence-portfolio-2026-deberry>

Focus Idea: Book Consultation.

Date: July 3 2026.

AI DISCLOSURE STATEMENT

I used Claude AI to help structure and format this document. The interview questions I asked the client, the client meeting notes, the requirement transformation, and the reflection are my own work that I wrote from the actual client interview. I am ready to explain and defend all parts of this submission.

Date	Tool	Prompt Summary	Output Used	Output Rejected	Verification
July 3, 2026	Claude	I prompted it to help me edit the interview write-up and transformation of requirement into nice Word document	Document layout and formatting.	Rejected any AI-written requirements.	Reviewed the full document against my interview notes before submission.

Current Flow

1. How do you usually handle your architectural projects day-to-day, and what's your go-to way for keeping clients in the loop?
2. Walk me through a project from start to finish; what does the journey look like from the moment a client first reaches out to the day you hand over the keys?

Pain Points

3. What are the biggest challenges you face when managing multiple projects at the same time?
4. Which parts of your current workflow consume the most time or cause the most frustration?

Data Requirements

5. What information do you collect from clients before starting a project?
6. What project documents or files do you need the system to store and manage?

Success Criteria

7. If we nail this system, what features would make you say, "Wow, this is exactly what our business needed"?
8. Six months down the road, how will you know this new system is actually working and making your life easier?

Security and Privacy

9. What specific information needs to stay strictly behind closed doors, and how high are the stakes for keeping your client data secure?
10. We know tech can be finicky. If a client accidentally uploads the wrong blueprint or their Wi-Fi drops mid-upload, how should the system handle it to keep things stress-free?

Additional Questions

11. Are there any features you would like to add to future versions of the system?
12. Is there anything about your current process that you would definitely want the new system to improve or replace?

Interview Evidence Summary

The group meeting with our client was held at UG LAW School. The meeting was held on July 2, 2026, at 10:00 AM. Participant role: DevOps/Release Lead. Evidence Type: Official client meeting minutes, compiled under docs/00-client-brief.md in the team repository

Summary

The face-to-face interview at the Law School focused on identifying how the firm delivers structural schematic drawings to external project stakeholders. The client walked through their current workflow, explaining that tracking project updates relies heavily on sending manual email attachments to clients. A key pain point that came up was that clients frequently review outdated blueprint attachments, which leads to miscommunication about active layout changes. The client was clear that the system must strictly separate user privileges: an Architect can create projects and upload architectural files, but a client must only be able to view their specific project timeline, download approved files, and request consultations.

C. Requirement Transformation

Raw client statement (from our group's interview): *"A Client must only be able to view their specific project timeline, download approved files, and request consultations."*

1. Functional Requirement: The system shall allow a Client to submit a consultation request for a specific project (with preferred date/time and topic), while restricting them from creating, editing, or deleting project files.

2. Non-Functional Requirement: Consultation request submissions shall be processed and confirmed to the client within 2 seconds under normal load, and role-based access checks shall reject any unauthorized file-modification attempt with a 403 response.

3. User Story: As a Client, I want to request a consultation about my project, so that I can discuss updates or concerns with the architect without needing full project access.

4. Acceptance Criteria

AC- 01: Given a logged-in Client viewing their assigned project, selecting "Request Consultation" displays a form for date, time, and topic.

AC- 02: A Client cannot submit a request for a project not assigned to them (403 Forbidden).

AC- 03: On submission, the assigned architect receives a notification with the request details.

AC- 04: The Client can view the status of their request (Pending/Confirmed/Declined).

AC- 05: A Client cannot edit or delete architectural files under any circumstance, including via the consultation flow.

5. System-Design Implications

API/Interface Implication: POST /api/projects/{project_id}/consultations — restricted to authenticated Client role, scoped to their own project_id. GET /api/consultations/{id} for status checks.

Data Implication: New Consultation model: id, project_id (FK), client_id (FK), requested_datetime, topic, status, created_at. Queries must filter by the requesting client's own client_id.

6. Test Idea: Integration test: authenticate as a Client, attempt POST a consultation request for a project_id not linked to that client's account, assert 403 Forbidden.

7. Open Question: Should consultation requests support attaching reference files or photos, or remain text-only in v1?

My reflections

After we had an in-person meeting with our client, the owner of Asamoah Welbeck & Associates, I assumed that the main challenge in the architecture firm's workflow would be file storage that clients simply needed a central place to find drawings instead of digging through email threads. Talking to the Architecture and Context Lead at Asamoah Welbeck & Associates changed that assumption. The real pain point wasn't storage; it was staleness: clients were reviewing outdated blueprint attachments and making decisions based on layouts that had already changed. That's a version-control and communication problem, not just a file-hosting one.

My assumption about user roles also shifted. I had pictured a fairly open system where clients could browse most project content. The client was explicit that access needed to be tightly scoped. A client should only see their own project timeline, download approved files, and request consultations, nothing more. This pushed me to think more seriously about role-based access control early in the design, rather than treating permissions as a later detail.

The consultation-request feature also surprised me. I initially thought "communication" meant better file-sharing. The client framed it instead as needing a structured way for clients to reach out for a conversation without giving them edit rights. That reframed a vague "improve communication" wish into a concrete, testable feature: a scoped consultation request endpoint with clear status tracking.

Overall, the interview weakened my assumption that this was primarily a document-management problem and strengthened my understanding that it's fundamentally about controlled visibility and structured communication between two very different user roles.

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